

Learning Log 9

- Course / Section: Teams and Technology, Section 202
- Week : 9
- Team NetIDs: jl4495, *szs27*
- Learning Goal: Strengthen active listening and communication skills for more effective team decisions and output.

1) Process notes lecture, readings, exercises

Lecture(absent)

Reading Note

Reading "Negotiation Analysis"

- ① Batnas → What will each party do if they don't agree?
- ② Parties → Who are the real and hidden decision-makers?
- ③ Interests → What are their underlying needs and priorities?
- ④ Value → How can value be created and distributed?
- ⑤ Barriers → What obstacles block agreement?
- ⑥ Power → How can influence shape outcomes?
- ⑦ Ethics → What's the right thing to do?

Batnas (Best Alternative to a Negotiated Agreement)

Key Idea:

[Your Batna is what you'll do deal is reached — not your ^{bottom} ~~bottom~~ line, but your best realistic alternative.]

Insights:

- > A good Batna strengthens your leverage; a poor one limits it but doesn't necessarily make you powerless.
- > The zone of possible agreement (ZOPA) lies between each party's walkaway points.
- > A rigid "bottom line" can block creative solutions.
- > Evaluating Batnas requires both rational analysis (decision science) and creative imagination (art).

Parties

- > Identify all real and hidden parties influencing the deal.

Video Note-

Lecture

- In most times, negotiation isn't a one-time event. It always get repeated.

~~Ex:~~

Ex: People might negotiate differently if they still need to interact with the person in future

↳ Not purely reaching a "price" as a goal.

> Core mindset

Negotiation = Any attempt to persuade / influence a situation or party. → Broader than haggling over price.

Relationship ⇒ = first, problem-solving orientation. Treat negotiations as ongoing relationship: ("serial event"), not one-off battles. Burning bridges hurts future deals.

> What makes negotiation effective

- Make the other side feel heard. Communication is showing you truly understand their concerns; credibility grows when people feel listened to.
- Aim for solutions that work for both sides. → Solving shared problem, not scoring points.

> Classic mistakes.

- Treating it like win/lose contest → Reframe as joint problem-solving and relationship building.
- Negotiating as if it's a one-time encounter → Assume you'll meet again; protect reputation and trust.
- Talking tactics before understanding interests → Listen first; confirm their priorities in their words.
- Jumping to money too early → Discuss role, scope, manager, start date, growth, etc., before compensation.

Exercise Note-

In this negotiation, Sally's agent wanted to help her make a career comeback, gain respect, and get fair pay, while the Lyric Opera wanted to avoid canceling the show, save money, and protect its reputation. Since both sides didn't have strong backup options, we needed to work together to find a deal. Instead of arguing over one number, we explored other ideas, like a base salary with a bonus, reaching free lessons for younger opera singers, and a shared publicity campaign ("Sally Soprano Returns"). Throughout the process, we wrote down things we discussed clearly, like the payment, promotion, and confidentiality to make sure we are on the same page.

Selfi-



2) Reflective engagement with the reflection framework (perceptual field, action repertoire, theory)

Perceptual Field

- I noticed that I often focus too much on numbers or outcomes rather than listening for deeper motivations.
- I was also afraid that my comments and claims might offend the others during the negotiation, which made me more cautious about how I phrased my ideas.
- I also noticed my mental bias as I often assume the other side was more powerful just because they represented an institution.

Action Repertoire

- I practiced pausing before responding and gave time for reflection.
- I tried summarizing what my partner said before presenting my own view.
- I experimented with shifting from “price negotiation” into “joint value creation.” and engaged in back and forth negotiation rather than one sided exchange.
- I tried to commit to explicitly mapping interests and BATNAs before any group negotiation.

Theory

Linked exercise to Wheeler’s framework (BATNA, Interests, Value, Barriers).

The turning point in our negotiation came exactly when I started to reframe the conversation around interests rather than positions. For example, instead of directly arguing about Sally’s salary baseline, I asked what success would look like for the Lyric Opera to uncover their real interest in avoiding a canceled show and tickets selling.

Connected Christensen’s emphasis on relationships to my teamwork habits.

His idea that negotiation is not one way to the end but cumulative trust-building reminded me of moments in my project team where maintaining a respectful tone when raising disagreements during a project meeting led to smoother collaboration later (when people are encouraged to raise their opinions because they trust that we will receive non-offensive response). For instance, after a tense critique session, I followed up with a teammate to acknowledge their idea, which improved our trust for the next meeting.

3) Reflective Engagement – How to negotiate effectively?

From the negotiation exercise and readings, I learned that effective information sharing starts with clarity (about everyone’s interest) and empathy. In both team settings and negotiations, people hold back information when they fear judgment or conflict. Using Christensen’s advice on communication, I realized that creating a respectful environment where everyone feels heard encourages openness to discover underlying interests, which helps moving along with the negotiation effectively. During our negotiation, when I summarized the other side’s points before

responding, it made them more willing to share details about their priorities. Similarly, in teams, repeating or paraphrasing others' ideas helps ensure understanding and builds trust, which leads to better decisions.

4) Reflective Engagement – Learning Goal

My learning goal was to strengthen active listening and communication skills for more effective teamwork. Through the Sally Soprano exercise, I practiced listening without interrupting and asking clarifying questions, building trust, instead of rushing to reach a negotiation deal. This helps me to develop more effective communication strategies even in future group meetings. The Wheeler reading reminded me that understanding others' interests before reacting prevents misunderstanding and ineffective communication, and Christensen's lecture showed how long-term relationships depend on how we communicate. I noticed that when I listened carefully and showed that I understood the other side, collaboration became much smoother and outcomes improved, which is a lesson I can carry into future team projects.